

# VOYAGER

## Product Requirements Document

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## 1. Product Vision

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Voyager is an AI-powered travel planning and trip companion app. It replaces the role of a travel agent — and goes beyond it. It builds a complete, personalised trip itinerary before departure, covering flights, accommodation, activities, transfers, and dining, then travels with the user as a live companion throughout the trip. The product covers the full journey lifecycle from initial planning through to the last day of travel, in a single seamless experience.

The core value proposition is that the hard work is done for the user, by an AI that thinks and responds like an expert travel agent combined with a local insider at every destination. Rather than researching across dozens of platforms and stitching together a trip manually, Voyager presents a fully built, deeply informed itinerary — personalised to budget, travel style, dates, and party size — and remains available throughout the trip to answer questions, provide local guidance, and surface details the user would otherwise never know to look for. All recommended elements link directly to live booking pages so the user can confirm each element in minimal taps.

Voyager differentiates from the market on four dimensions: the depth of travel agent and local knowledge embedded into every recommendation; AI personalisation that goes well beyond generic itinerary generation; design quality that matches premium consumer apps; and the dual role of planner plus companion — a combination no competitor has fully delivered.

## 2. Target User

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The primary user is a traveller who has a destination and dates in mind but finds trip planning time-consuming and fragmented. They are comfortable booking travel independently but want the thinking done for them. They value quality recommendations over cheap options and expect a polished, intuitive mobile experience.

Secondary users include frequent travellers who want a reliable single tool for every trip, and travellers taking complex multi-destination itineraries where manual planning becomes genuinely difficult.

## 3. Business Model

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### 3.1 Core Revenue — Percentage-Based Trip Unlock Fee

Voyager charges a direct, transparent fee to unlock each trip plan. The fee is calculated as a percentage of the estimated total trip value, with a complexity multiplier applied on top. There are no subscriptions, no credit packs, and no rigid fixed pricing — the fee scales naturally with the value delivered, mirroring exactly how a travel agent operates.

Travel agents typically earn 10–15% commission on accommodation and packaged holidays, 5–10% on flights, and 15–20% on tours and cruises — blending to approximately 10–12% across a full trip. Voyager’s fee sits at a fraction of that: a base rate of approximately 0.75% of estimated trip value, adjusted by complexity. The user gets a better outcome than a travel agent delivers, faster, at a fraction of the cost.

The fee is shown transparently at the preview stage — before the user commits to paying. They see the estimated trip value, the complexity tier, and the resulting unlock fee. No surprises at checkout.

*Example: A NZD \$3,500 Australian trip at base rate = approximately NZD \$26 unlock fee. A NZD \$12,000 Europe family trip with high complexity multiplier (1.5x) = approximately NZD \$135. These figures reflect meaningful value delivery relative to total spend and are well below what a travel agent would charge for equivalent planning.*

### 3.2 Complexity Multiplier — Four-Factor Algorithm

The complexity multiplier is calculated from four independent factors assessed at itinerary build time. The four factor scores are averaged to produce the final multiplier, capped at 1.5x maximum. A solo weekend in a single city sits at 1.0x. A multi-country family trip with complex logistics and a larger group approaches the cap. The multiplier captures not just trip complexity but also the increased value Voyager delivers and the increased coordination involved in larger, more complex trips.

| Factor          | 1.0x                          | 1.1x                                          | 1.2x                                             | 1.3x                                        |
|-----------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Trip duration   | Under 7 nights                | 7–14 nights                                   | 15–28 nights                                     | Over 28 nights                              |
| Destinations    | Single destination            | Two destinations                              | Three or more                                    | Multi-country                               |
| Party size      | 1–2 travellers                | 3–4 travellers                                | 5–8 travellers                                   | 9+ travellers                               |
| Trip complexity | Simple — flights + hotel only | Moderate — mix of transport and accommodation | High — rail passes, car hire, multiple transport | Very high — transport, multi-group activity |

Example calculation: A 28-night multi-country trip for 4 people with flights, rail passes, and car hire scores 1.2x (duration) + 1.3x (destinations) + 1.1x (party size) + 1.2x (complexity) = 1.2x averaged multiplier. At 0.75% base rate on NZD \$11,400 trip value: NZD \$85.50 x 1.2x = NZD \$103 unlock fee.

*The four factors and their weightings are server-side configuration. They can be adjusted at any time without a product rebuild. Party size feeds directly from the onboarding input. Destination count and complexity are assessed by the AI at build time. The final multiplier and its component factors are shown transparently to the user at the preview stage.*

#### 3.2a Group Travel — How Party Size is Captured and Applied

Group travel is handled entirely within the complexity multiplier model. There is no separate per-traveller fee or companion access charge. The party size entered at onboarding feeds directly into the multiplier calculation, meaning larger groups result in a higher unlock fee that reflects the greater coordination, value delivered, and trip complexity inherent in group travel. This is the cleanest approach for V1 and can be recalibrated by adjusting the party size factor weightings at any time.

Within the product, group travellers are managed as follows:

| Aspect               | How it works                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Traveller invitation | Trip owner shares an invite link or email from the Trip tab. Invited travellers join via their own Voyager account or |

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Shared itinerary</b>    | All travellers see the full shared itinerary — flights, accommodation, transfers, group meals, and shared activities.                                          |
| <b>Activity tagging</b>    | Each itinerary activity is tagged as Shared (all travellers) or Individual (specific person). Individual activities appear only to the person who booked them. |
| <b>Individual bookings</b> | Each traveller can add their own activities to their personal layer of the itinerary. These are visible to the trip owner and other travellers.                |
| <b>Booking visibility</b>  | Trip owner sees all bookings — shared and individual — across all travellers. Each traveller sees shared bookings and their own individual bookings.           |
| <b>Revenue model</b>       | One unlock fee per trip, incorporating party size in the multiplier. No secondary charges per traveller. Simple and transparent.                               |

### 3.3 Fee Flexibility & Refunds

Voyager does not use credit packs or top-up balances. Each trip is priced and paid for individually at the point of unlock. This removes the rigidity of fixed pack sizes and ensures every type of traveller — occasional weekend tripper through to frequent long-haul traveller — is well served without feeling forced into a bundle that does not match their needs.

Refund policy: the preview-before-payment mechanic is the primary protection against disputes — users see sufficient detail to make an informed decision before any fee is charged. Once unlocked, fees are non-refundable as the full itinerary has been delivered. If a technical failure prevents delivery, a full refund is issued. NZ Consumer Law obligations apply and are built into the refund policy from the outset.

### 3.4 Liability & Insurance Position

Voyager does not charge a separate assurance or protection fee. This decision mirrors how travel agents operate — a travel agent's professional liability is covered by their own indemnity insurance, not charged to the customer as an add-on. Charging customers for protection against potential Voyager errors would be difficult to justify and would undermine trust.

Voyager's business liability exposure is managed through professional indemnity insurance held by the company. The customer's own exposure — cancelled flights, medical emergencies, trip interruption — is covered by travel insurance, which Voyager refers as an add-on at the point of unlock. These two layers provide complete coverage without a separate Voyager product sitting between them.

### 3.5 Add-On Revenue

At the point of trip unlock — highest purchase intent — Voyager presents relevant travel products the user will need. Because the app knows exactly where they are going, when, for how long, and with whom, these recommendations are highly contextual rather than generic advertising.

| Product            | Model                      | Notes                                                          |
|--------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| eSIM               | Reseller margin / referral | Destination-specific, duration matched to trip                 |
| Travel Insurance   | Referral fee               | Presented at unlock with trip dates and destination pre-filled |
| Currency Card / FX | Referral fee               | International trips with currency change                       |
| Airport Transfers  | Referral fee               | Matched to arrival/departure airports in itinerary             |

### 3.6 What We Are Not Doing

Voyager is not a booking engine and will not take commission on bookings. Affiliate partnerships with airlines, hotels, or OTAs are explicitly excluded from V1 — they restrict what can be recommended, introduce API dependency, and limit the comprehensiveness that is central to the product value.

Subscription pricing and credit packs are both excluded — direct percentage-based fees are cleaner, more

transparent, and scale better with value delivered.

## 4. Core Product Features

### 4.1 Trip Planning — AI Itinerary Builder

The user inputs: destination(s), travel dates, party size, budget range, and travel style preferences. The AI builds a complete day-by-day itinerary covering flights, accommodation, activities, dining, and transfers. The itinerary is personalised — it reflects the user's specific inputs rather than returning a generic result — and draws on deep embedded knowledge of every destination, exactly as a skilled travel agent would.

The AI's knowledge layer is what separates Voyager from generic itinerary generators. It encompasses destination-specific intelligence across countries, cities, neighbourhoods, flight routes, hotel tiers, local food culture, 'cultural norms, visa requirements, seasonal considerations, transport options, tipping conventions, safety context, and the kind of insider knowledge that local guides and experienced agents carry. This knowledge is woven into every recommendation — not surfaced as a separate tips section, but embedded into the itinerary itself so every choice reflects genuine expertise.

Sources informing the knowledge layer include destination management organisation content, travel industry training materials, independent travel guides, and curated traveller insight from established travel communities. The intent is that a user planning a trip to Japan, Morocco, or Patagonia receives recommendations that reflect real on-the-ground knowledge of those places — not a list of the most-searched attractions.

A preview of the itinerary is shown before payment. The preview is the single most critical conversion moment in the product — it must answer three questions simultaneously: Is this personalised to my trip? Is the quality good enough to trust? Is the fee worth what I am getting? If any one of these is not answered convincingly, the user does not pay.

#### 4.1a Preview — What Is Shown

The preview contains four elements, each serving a specific purpose in the conversion flow:

| Element                 | What the User Sees                                                                                                                                                                    | Purpose                                                                            |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Destination Overview    | A specific, personalised opening paragraph about the trip to the destination, stating the specific style. Established general                                                         | Provides the destination, dates, party size, and travel style. Establishes general |
| Trip Structure          | High-level day-by-day outline showing the shape of the trip. Shows the user the day titles and booking links visible to every day.                                                    | Shows the user the day titles and booking links visible to every day.              |
| One Unlocked Sample Day | One complete day shown in full — specific hotel recommendations, activities, dining, and transfers. The end of the sample day is locked. Provides the full details and booking links. | The end of the sample day is locked. Provides the full details and booking links.  |
| Fee Presentation        | Recommended trip value, complexity tier, and unlock fee. Transparent and honest about the price. Shows the value of the trip.                                                         | Transparent and honest about the price. Shows the value of the trip.               |

#### 4.1b Preview — What Stays Locked

All specific detail beyond the sample day is locked until payment: hotel names and booking links for every other day, restaurant recommendations, activity booking links, transfer details, and all Duffel booking integration. The Voyager Ask feature and companion mode are also locked. The locked content is visible in outline form — the user can see the structure — but the detail that makes it actionable requires unlocking.

*Design principle: the preview should feel like looking through a window at something genuinely valuable, not a teaser for something that might be good. The one unlocked sample day carries the conversion weight. If that day is*

exceptional — specific, locally informed, well-reasoned — the user pays to see the rest. The sample day chosen for preview should be the strongest day in the itinerary, not Day 1 which is typically arrival and least representative of quality.

4.1d Itinerary Editing — Before and After Unlock

The itinerary is never fixed and handed to the user. At every stage — preview, post-unlock, and during the companion phase — the user can remove, swap, or adapt elements. This mirrors how a good travel agent operates: they present a plan and refine it until the client is happy. Voyager does the same.

In the preview, the sample day's activities can be removed or flagged as unwanted. After unlock, every day is fully editable — activities can be removed, alternatives requested, or entirely new elements added. When an element is removed, Voyager can suggest alternatives based on the same destination knowledge that built the original recommendation. When the scope of the trip changes materially, the fee is recalculated transparently before any additional charge is made.

4.1e Language & Positioning Principles

Voyager never describes its recommendations as AI-generated or AI-built. This language degrades perceived value — it implies automated, generic, and impersonal output. The value Voyager delivers is expert curation, local knowledge, and a plan built specifically for this person and this trip. The language reflects that.

| Avoid                  | Use instead                             |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| AI-generated itinerary | Your trip plan, built by Voyager        |
| AI recommendations     | Expert recommendations, Curated for you |
| AI suggests            | Voyager recommends                      |
| Generated by AI        | Built for you                           |
| AI travel planner      | Voyager — your travel expert            |

No hidden fees messaging must appear at every point where a fee is shown — not just the unlock screen. The standard line is: 'This is the only Voyager charge. Every flight, hotel, and activity is booked at its standard published price — no markup, no commission.' Travellers are conditioned to expect hidden costs from travel products. This expectation must be actively dismantled at every fee touchpoint.

4.1c Onboarding & Trip Input — Three Paths

Voyager offers three entry paths into the itinerary build. All three feed the same AI build engine and produce the same quality of output — the paths simply serve different user types and planning styles. The default entry point is the Standard Form. The other two paths are clearly signposted at the start of the trip input flow.

| Path              | Who It Serves                       | What It Involves                                                              | Build Complexity   |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Standard Form     | Users who know what they want       | Travelers specify the origin, destination, dates, number of adults, priority  | Simple build       |
| Detailed Form     | Planners who want granular control  | Same as standard form, but with more detail options                           | More complex build |
| Conversation Mode | Exploratory planners, complex trips | Open-ended dialogue with Voyager, user describes the trip in natural language | Most complex build |

Users may also switch between paths mid-flow. A user starting the standard form who wants to add more context can expand to the detailed form or switch to conversation mode at any point before the build begins. A user in conversation mode who wants to confirm specific parameters can be shown a structured

summary for review before the build is triggered.

The build progress indicator is a deliberate part of the experience across all three paths. Rather than a generic loading spinner, it shows the user what the AI is doing in real time — 'Finding the best flights from Auckland...', 'Researching London neighbourhoods...', 'Building your day-by-day itinerary...' This creates perceived value before the preview appears and sets the quality expectation correctly.

*Rationale: different users plan travel differently. A single form path loses users who find forms reductive for a complex trip. Conversation mode alone would alienate users who want speed and structure. Three paths with a shared build engine maximises top-of-funnel conversion without compromising output quality. The detailed form serves the power user without adding friction to the default experience.*

4.2 Booking Integration — Duffel API

Voyager uses the Duffel API as the primary booking integration for flights, accommodation, and car rental. Duffel provides a single API connection covering 300+ airlines, 1 million+ hotel properties, and 40 global car rental providers across 40,000 locations in 200 countries. No IATA accreditation is required — Duffel handles this on Voyager's behalf.

The Duffel integration means all flight, hotel, and car rental search results are displayed directly within the Voyager interface with correct parameters — passengers, dates, cabin class, location — passed through accurately. The user never hits a broken link or empty search page. All booking is handled seamlessly inside the app.

| Category                                                            | V1 Integration                            | Coverage                                                             | Commercial Model                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Flights                                                             | Duffel API                                | 300+ airlines globally — full service, budget, and low-cost carriers | Pay per booking — USD \$3.50 per booking      |
| Hotels                                                              | Duffel Stays API + Booking.com deep links | 1M+ hotel properties. Booking.com affiliate covers 200+ countries    | Duffel 20% commission on completed stays      |
| Accommodation — Apartments/Homes                                    | Not API accessible                        | Airbnb does not expose inventory to third-party APIs                 | Separate Airbnb link with disclaimer          |
| Car Rental                                                          | Duffel Cars API                           | 40 global providers across 40,000 locations in 200 countries         | 20% commission on completed bookings          |
| Rail & Ground Transport — Europe, UK, North America, Japan, SE Asia | Official rail APIs                        | European rail, Japan Shinkansen, etc.                                | Affiliate or Passes (Amtrak/VIA Rail, etc.)   |
| Rail & Ground Transport — China, India                              | Deep links                                | China domestic rail (CRH) and India domestic rail (IRCTC)            | Affiliate or commission on completed bookings |
| Activities                                                          | Viator + GetYourGuide deep links          | Global activities and experiences. Confirmed working on test trip    | Affiliate or commission on completed bookings |
| Local Transport Passes                                              | External links only                       | Oyster (London), IC Card (Japan), Opal (Australia), etc.             | Voyager cannot handle directly                |

4.3 Accommodation — Hotel vs Airbnb Decision

For every accommodation recommendation, Voyager explicitly presents two options: a hotel via the Duffel Stays API, or an Airbnb-style stay. The AI recommends which suits the specific trip — hotels for short stays, business-adjacent trips, and late bookings; apartments and home stays for longer trips, families, self-catering destinations, or where a local neighbourhood experience adds more value than a hotel.

This recommendation with rationale is part of the travel agent knowledge layer — a great agent doesn't default to hotels, they advise on the right accommodation type for the specific trip. The user makes the final choice. If they select Airbnb, they book directly on the Airbnb platform and confirm via the share sheet on return. The AI parses the Airbnb confirmation and populates the itinerary element identically to a hotel booking. The experience is consistent regardless of which accommodation type is chosen.

*Airbnb does not expose its inventory through third-party APIs — no provider can integrate Airbnb listings directly. This is an industry-wide constraint, not a Voyager limitation. Being transparent about this in the product ('book on Airbnb and import your confirmation') is the honest and correct approach.*

4.3a Rail & Ground Transport Booking

Rail and ground transport is a first-class booking element alongside flights and car rental. When rail or coach is the recommended transport option for a leg of the trip, it appears in the itinerary with booking access — not as a secondary suggestion. Two providers cover the full global picture for V1:

| Provider                          | Coverage                                                                                                                     | Status    |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Omio (deep links)                 | Europe, UK, North America, Japan, Southeast Asia — 47 countries. Covers UK National Rail at depth.                           | Deep link |
| Trip.com (deep links)             | China domestic rail (CRH) and India domestic rail (IRCTC) — closed systems inaccessible elsewhere.                           | Deep link |
| Trainline Partner Solutions (API) | European rail at depth — full in-app booking, no context switch. Enterprise partnership requiring traffic and revenue share. | API       |

Local transport passes (London Oyster, Tokyo IC Card, Sydney Opal, etc.) cannot be booked via any third-party API — these are handled as recommendations with a direct purchase link. Voyager's AI determines which transport provider to surface based on destination — the user sees 'Book train' not the provider name.

Provider invisibility principle: the booking technology behind each element is never surfaced to the user. 'Flights', 'Train', 'Hotel', 'Car hire' are the labels used — never the API or affiliate provider powering the link. The experience is Voyager throughout. Post-launch, deep links upgrade to direct API integrations as commercial terms become viable.

4.4 Booking Confirmation & Trip Tracking

Once the user completes a booking externally, they return to the app to record it. The confirmation flow works as follows:

- 1. User taps back into Voyager after booking. A prompt appears: 'Did you book this?'
- 2. User taps Yes and is presented with a single input: share your confirmation.
- 3. On mobile, the user taps the native Share button on their booking confirmation email and selects Voyager from the share sheet. The full confirmation text is received by the app automatically.
- 4. The AI parses the confirmation (flight number, times, route, hotel name, dates, reference number) and populates the itinerary element with the confirmed details.
- 5. The element is marked as booked in the trip view.

The share sheet integration is standard on iOS and Android and requires no email access permissions. The user controls what they share. This approach avoids the privacy concerns of inbox access while eliminating manual data entry.

4.5 Voyager Ask — Interactive Travel Knowledge

Voyager Ask is the interactive knowledge layer — the travel agent and local expert companion available at every stage of the journey. It is not a chatbot, not a search bar, and not an FAQ. It is a knowledgeable companion that knows the user's specific trip, anticipates what they need to know, and answers whatever they ask — before they depart, while they are booking, and on the ground during travel.

4.5a Voyager Ask — Two Modes

Voyager Ask combines two modes within a single interface, both available simultaneously on the Ask tab:

| Mode                   | What It Does                                                         | When It Appears                           | Example                                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Contextual Prompt Feed | Proactive, AI-generated prompts relevant to the user's current trip. | Pre-trip, during the trip, and post-trip. | "Did you book your train to Paris?"    |
| Chat Input             | Open chat interface always available.                                | Always available.                         | "What's the best time to visit Paris?" |

4.5b Voyager Ask — Placement & UI

Voyager Ask lives as a dedicated tab in the bottom navigation bar — a first-class citizen of the app with the same prominence as the itinerary view. This positioning signals that Ask is a core feature, not a support tool. It is always one tap away regardless of where the user is in the app.

Within itinerary elements, contextual 'Tell me more' prompts appear on individual cards — hotel recommendations, day summaries, activity listings, neighbourhood descriptions. Tapping these opens the Ask tab pre-populated with a relevant question. This creates a natural connection between the itinerary and the knowledge layer without requiring the user to navigate independently.

4.5c Voyager Ask — Knowledge Scope

The knowledge scope mirrors what an exceptional travel agent combined with a well-travelled local would know. It covers: neighbourhood character and safety context, flight and transit logistics, airport navigation, accommodation area context, local food culture and dining customs, tipping norms, cultural etiquette, visa and entry requirements, currency and payment conventions, transport options between cities and within destinations, seasonal and weather considerations, packing guidance by destination and trip duration, and practical trip-specific logistics for every leg of the journey.

Critically, Ask is trip-aware. It knows the user's destination, travel dates, party composition, accommodation, and booked elements. Responses are always contextualised to their specific trip rather than generic destination information. 'What should I pack?' returns a packing list for their actual destinations, duration, and season — not a generic travel packing guide.

*Positioning: Voyager Ask is the travel agent in your pocket for the entire journey. This is the feature that makes Voyager a companion, not just a planner. No competitor offers a trip-aware, proactive and reactive knowledge layer at this depth. It is a primary differentiator and a key driver of post-unlock retention and daily engagement.*

4.5d Voyager Ask — Access Model

Voyager Ask is available in two access tiers:

| Tier               | Access                                                     | Limit       | Rationale                                                             |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pre-unlock (free)  | Available from the moment a trip is started before payment | 3 questions | Demonstrates knowledge quality to support conversion. Low API cost    |
| Post-unlock (full) | Fully unlocked after payment, unlimited duration           | Unlimited   | Full trip-aware companion. Active from unlock through to the last day |

When the free limit is reached, a soft prompt appears: 'Unlock your itinerary to get unlimited Voyager Ask throughout your trip.' This is not a hard wall — it is a contextual nudge at a moment when the user has already experienced the value of Ask and is most likely to convert. The 3-question limit is sufficient to demonstrate quality without giving away meaningful planning value.

*Ask is not available as a standalone pre-trip research tool outside of an active trip build. Conversation mode in the onboarding flow handles general destination discovery. This keeps the value of Ask clearly tied to the trip and the unlock, and avoids positioning it as a free general-purpose travel chatbot.*

4.5e Voyager Memory — Explicit Preferences & Learned Personalisation

Voyager improves the quality of every itinerary it builds through three distinct mechanisms: explicit user preferences, per-user learned memory, and global aggregated learning. These are separate systems with different privacy implications and serve different purposes. Together they mean Voyager gets better both for the individual user over time and for the product as a whole.

| Layer                      | What it is                                             | How it works                                                                           | Privacy                                                    |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Explicit preferences       | Structured data the user provides directly             | User-defined for dietary requirements, arrival preferences, flight, transport, luggage | Private preferences, not shared or aggregated              |
| Per-user learned memory    | Patterns inferred from a user's own behaviour          | Observed from their trips, reviews, and subscriptions                                  | Private, as the user should know it, weighted by frequency |
| Global aggregated learning | Patterns observed across all users for anonymised data | Anonymised and aggregated at the device level                                          | Anonymous, not shared or aggregated                        |

Explicit Preferences — Fields

Captured once in account settings (not per-trip), explicit preferences persist across every future trip and are surfaced to the user as editable at any time. Fields are grouped logically:

| Category         | Fields                                                                                                           |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Travel logistics | Home airport/city, preferred airlines, frequent flyer programmes (airline + membership number, multiple entries) |
| Accommodation    | Hotel loyalty programmes, accommodation type preference (hotel/apartment/boutique)                               |
| Food & dietary   | Dietary requirements (vegetarian, vegan, allergies, etc.), food preferences and dislikes                         |
| Accessibility    | Mobility requirements, accessibility needs for accommodation and activities                                      |
| General          | Free text field — 'anything else Voyager should always know'                                                     |

Explicit preferences are optional at every field — a new user with nothing filled in gets the same quality itinerary as today, just without the personalisation layer. The more a user provides, the more tailored the output. This is communicated in the UI as 'the more Voyager knows, the better your trips get.'

V1 scope: explicit preferences and per-user learned memory are both included. Global aggregated learning is a V2 consideration — it requires sufficient user volume and trip data to produce meaningful patterns, and the anonymisation architecture needs dedicated design work before any aggregate learning is implemented. Documented here as the long-term direction, not a V1 build commitment.

4.6 Trip Companion — Full Feature Set

Once elements are confirmed, Voyager becomes a live trip companion covering the full journey from the weeks before departure through to arriving home. The companion is the primary differentiator — most competitors are either planners or organisers. Voyager is both, with a proactive companion layer neither category currently provides.

| Feature               | What It Does                                                                                       | When Active                                                     |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Day-by-day itinerary  | Live view with booked vs unbooked status, booking references, and trip-related details             | End-trip and design travel complete outstanding bookings        |
| Day-ahead suggestions | Proactive nudges for the following day — early opening times, where to eat, local tips for the day | During travel, unbooked days, and local tips for the day        |
| Booking timing alerts | Surfaces when specific bookings can now be made — restaurants, popular attractions, etc.           | Pre-trip, triggered at the right time with limited availability |
| Packing list          | Destination and duration-aware packing list built specifically for the trip                        | Pre-trip — weather, activities, location. User can change       |
| Currency converter    | Destination currencies pre-loaded from the itinerary. No setup.                                    | Pre-trip and during travel.                                     |
| Weather               | Relevant forecast for current or next destination. Not a full weather service.                     | During travel — day before the trip ahead.                      |
| Local emergency info  | Nearest hospital to each hotel, local emergency number, travel insurance details                   | Available throughout the trip on arrival                        |
| Time zone tracking    | Tracks current time zone and converts key times — especially useful for multi-destination trips    | Multi-destination trips                                         |
| Etiquette reminders   | Tipping norms, cultural customs, local behaviours surfaced at relevant points                      | During travel, context-triggered                                |
| Offline access        | Core itinerary, hotel addresses, booking references, and emergency contacts                        | During travel, available without signal                         |
| Voyager Ask           | Full interactive knowledge layer — proactive feed and open chat                                    | Pre-trip and during travel                                      |

The companion does not wait to be asked. Proactive features — day-ahead suggestions, booking timing alerts, weather, etiquette reminders — surface at the right moment without the user having to think to look for them. The interactive layer handles everything they do want to ask. Together these replicate what a great travel companion provides: anticipation of needs and availability on demand.

*Future companion features will be added as they are identified through user feedback and product iteration. The companion scope documented here represents V1. The architecture is designed to accommodate new features without structural changes to the core product.*

## 5. Technical Architecture — Confirmed Stack

The following stack has been confirmed for V1. All decisions are locked. A detailed technical specification will be produced separately prior to build.

| Layer           | Technology                   | Purpose                                                                           |
|-----------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Version Control | GitHub                       | Code repository. Single source of truth for all code. Vercel connects directly to |
| Frontend        | Next.js + Tailwind CSS       | Single codebase handling both web app and mobile-optimised experience. Nex        |
| Database & Auth | Supabase                     | Postgres database with built-in authentication. Handles user accounts, trip stor  |
| Payments        | Stripe                       | Handles the percentage-based unlock fee calculation and processing. Works g       |
| AI Model        | Claude API via Vercel AI SDK | Powers itinerary generation and Voyager Ask. Vercel AI SDK wraps the API ca       |
| Hosting         | Vercel                       | Connects to GitHub repo. Auto-deploys on every push. Free tier covers early s     |

### 5.1 Platform

Web-first for V1. A responsive web app avoids App Store dependency, allows faster iteration, and reaches both iOS and Android users without a native build. Native apps for iOS and Android are a V2 consideration once the product is validated.

### 5.2 AI Model Abstraction Layer

All AI calls — itinerary generation and Voyager Ask — are routed through a single service module within the codebase. This module accepts standardised inputs and returns standardised outputs regardless of which model sits underneath. Swapping the AI provider at any point (e.g. moving to GPT-4o or Gemini at scale) requires updating only this module and the API credentials — no other part of the codebase is affected.

Starting model: Claude API. Cost review to be conducted when paid trip volume reaches a meaningful threshold. At that point a tiered model approach may be introduced — a lighter, cheaper model for Standard complexity trips and Claude retained for Complex and High Complexity trips where quality has the greatest impact on conversion.

*Rationale: Claude produces the highest quality itinerary output at this stage and directly affects conversion rate. API cost at early volume is negligible relative to marketing spend. Optimising for cost before scale is premature and adds unnecessary complexity.*

### 5.3 No Inventory Dependency

Voyager does not hold, check, or manage inventory. All availability and pricing is live on the destination platform. This eliminates a significant category of backend complexity and keeps the product focused on intelligence and curation rather than transaction processing.

### 5.4 Share Sheet Integration

Booking confirmation import uses native iOS and Android share sheet functionality. Voyager registers as a share target. When a user shares a confirmation email to Voyager, the app receives the full text and parses it via AI to extract structured booking data. No email access, no OAuth to mail providers, no inbox scanning.

### 5.5 Payment Processing — Stripe

Voyager uses Stripe for all payment processing. The unlock fee is calculated server-side after the AI builds the full itinerary, using the actual recommended trip value rather than a rough estimate from user inputs. The formula is: recommended trip value x 0.75% base rate x complexity multiplier = unlock fee. This amount is passed to Stripe as a dynamic charge at checkout.

The user sees the fee transparently at the preview stage — trip value, complexity tier, and resulting fee — before any payment is required. Stripe processes the payment via payment intent, meaning the charge is only confirmed when the user explicitly approves. Stripe's standard NZ card fee (approximately 1.5% + NZD \$0.30) is factored into margin calculations.

For trip scope changes post-unlock — extended duration, additional destinations — Voyager recalculates the fee from the updated itinerary and presents any increment transparently before charging. Minor changes such as date shifts do not trigger additional fees. The fee structure can be adjusted at any time through server-side configuration without any frontend changes.

*Decision: fee is calculated from the full AI-built itinerary, not estimated from user inputs alone. Build-first pricing is more accurate (5-10% variance vs 30-40%), more transparent to the user, and builds more trust at the critical conversion moment. The AI build cost per itinerary is negligible against unlock fee revenue.*

## 6. Core User Flow — V1

| Step                              | What Happens                                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Onboarding                     | User creates account. Minimal fields — name, email, password. Immediately presented with three trip in     |
| 2. New Trip — Standard Form       | Two screens. Screen 1: origin, destination, dates, travellers. Screen 2: budget tier, travel style, accomm |
| 2. New Trip — Detailed Form       | Same two screens as standard with 'Add more detail' expansion revealing additional fields: preferred air   |
| 2. New Trip — Conversation Mode   | Open chat with Voyager. User describes trip naturally. AI asks clarifying questions, extracts parameters,  |
| 3. AI Builds Itinerary            | Full day-by-day plan generated with specific recommendations — flights, hotels, activities, dining, transf |
| 4. Preview                        | User sees itinerary overview — enough to evaluate quality and see the recommended trip value. Unlock       |
| 5. Unlock Payment                 | User pays unlock fee via Stripe. Fee covers the planning and curation — not the bookings. Full itinerary   |
| 6. Add-On Offers                  | eSIM, travel insurance, travel insurance referral, currency card, and airport transfers presented contextu |
| 7. Booking — Flights & Hotels     | User books flights, hotels, and car rental directly within Voyager via Duffel API. All parameters passed c |
| 8. Booking — Activities           | User taps activity deep links to Viator or GetYourGuide. Pre-filtered search opens with destination and d  |
| 9. Booking — Accommodation Choice | For accommodation, user chooses hotel (via Duffel) or Airbnb-style stay (external). Airbnb bookings con    |
| 10. Confirmation Import           | All booking confirmations imported via native share sheet. AI parses and populates itinerary elements w    |

|                    |                                                                                                           |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11. Companion Mode | Trip live view active. Day-by-day itinerary, booked vs unbooked status, booking references, countdown t   |
| 12. Trip Changes   | If user extends or changes trip scope materially, Voyager rebuilds affected portion. Any fee increment ca |

## 7. Competitor Analysis

The following apps represent the current competitive landscape. None has fully delivered the combination of AI-powered pre-trip planning and live companion functionality that Voyager targets.

### Stippl — 1.5 million users

#### BUSINESS MODEL

Freemium subscription. Free tier for core planning; Stippl Premium for advanced AI, offline access, and collaboration. eSIM sales as a transactional revenue layer.

#### STRENGTHS

Large user base. AI itinerary generation (fast). Offline functionality. eSIM for 190+ countries built in. Collaboration tools.

#### WEAKNESSES

Rigid planning structure with noticeable learning curve. Significant user complaints about reliability — buttons not working, features broken on a funded, shipped product. AI personalisation is surface-level; itineraries are generic.

#### VOYAGER ANGLE

Voyager's design quality and genuine AI personalisation addresses Stippl's core weaknesses. The per-trip model avoids the subscription friction that Stippl's free tier is designed to overcome.

### Tripsy — Apple ecosystem only

#### BUSINESS MODEL

One-time App Store purchase (~USD \$4.99) plus optional annual subscription for premium features. Low recurring revenue — indie app economics.

#### STRENGTHS

Reliable. Imports trip details from forwarded emails. Live flight alerts. Apple Watch sync. Calendar export. Clean, focused UX.

#### WEAKNESSES

iOS only — excludes Android users. Primarily an organiser, not a planner. Does not help build a trip, only organises one already planned elsewhere. One-star reviews for inability to merge trips.

#### VOYAGER ANGLE

Tripsy's reliability and utility features (live alerts, email import) set a table-stakes benchmark. Voyager's share sheet import is the equivalent of Tripsy's email forwarding but without inbox access. The planning layer is where Voyager extends well beyond Tripsy.

### Funliday — Discovery and collaboration focused

#### **BUSINESS MODEL**

Free with in-app purchases. Guides and discovery content as a monetisation layer — moving toward affiliate/content model.

#### **STRENGTHS**

Place discovery. Collaboration features. Own curated guides.

#### **WEAKNESSES**

Slow performance. Limited to its own guide content — cannot recommend the best option across the open web. Not a comprehensive planner.

#### **VOYAGER ANGLE**

Funliday's content restriction is the key contrast. Voyager is not limited to its own guide library — it can surface the best option for any destination, any category, from across the web.

### **Triplt — Established product, 15+ years**

#### **BUSINESS MODEL**

Freemium. Free tier for basic itinerary organisation. Triplt Pro (~USD \$49/year) adds real-time flight alerts, seat tracking, and fare refund notifications. Acquired by SAP Concur — enterprise/corporate travel is the real business now.

#### **STRENGTHS**

Itinerary organisation from forwarded booking emails. Real-time flight alerts. Seat tracking. Fare refund monitoring. Deep utility for frequent business travellers.

#### **WEAKNESSES**

Not a planner — purely an organiser of bookings made elsewhere. UI described as dated despite 15+ years of iteration. Consumer product is largely a funnel to the enterprise offering.

#### **VOYAGER ANGLE**

Triplt's email-import mechanic is a proven UX pattern that validates the confirmation import approach. The planning gap is wide — Triplt does nothing to help a user decide where to stay or what to do.

## **8. Design Direction**

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The design intent established in the prototype is a deliberate point of differentiation. The aesthetic is warm, premium, and editorial — closer to Headspace or Airbnb than a utility travel tool. None of the competitors have produced a visually distinctive experience; most default to functional but generic UI patterns.

Design system: warm amber and terracotta palette. Playfair Display for headings, DM Sans for body. Card-based layout with generous whitespace. Bottom tab navigation for mobile.

The design must hold at both the planning stage (aspirational, discovery-oriented) and the companion stage (functional, quick-access). These are different emotional contexts and the UI should flex accordingly — richer visual treatment during planning, clean utility during the trip itself.

## **9. V1 Scope & Exclusions**

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## In Scope for V1

AI itinerary builder with full day-by-day output. Percentage-based per-trip unlock fee with complexity multiplier. Transparent fee display at preview stage. Deep links to external booking platforms via search parameters. Share sheet booking confirmation import. Trip companion view with booked/unbooked status. Group travel — traveller invitation via share link, shared vs individual activity tagging, cross-traveller booking visibility. Add-on product presentation at unlock (eSIM, travel insurance, currency card, airport transfers).

## Explicitly Out of Scope for V1

Native iOS and Android apps (web-first only). Booking API integrations — no inventory held, no payment processing. Affiliate partnerships with OTAs or airlines. Subscription pricing. Email inbox access or OAuth to mail providers. Offline functionality. Real-time flight alerts. Multi-user collaboration. Social or sharing features.

## V2 Candidates

Native mobile apps. Email parsing via inbox integration (if user appetite exists). Apple Wallet and Google Wallet reading for automated booking import. Real-time flight status. Offline companion mode. Group trip collaboration.

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# 10. Future Revenue Streams — Post V1

The following revenue streams are not part of the initial build. They are captured here because they arose naturally during product scoping and represent a clear growth roadmap as user numbers scale. Each is a logical extension of the core product rather than a pivot.

## 10.1 In-App Advertising

As user volume grows, Voyager's audience becomes a genuinely valuable advertising inventory. Users are travel-intent, destination-confirmed, and date-specific — targeting data that is far superior to generic display advertising. Advertisers in airlines, hotel groups, travel gear, luggage, experience providers, and currency products are natural partners.

Advertising will be restricted to the companion view — post-unlock, post-payment. It must not appear in the planning or preview stages where it would undermine the premium positioning. Ad categories will be curated to travel-relevant brands only. CPM rates will be premium given the quality of targeting data available.

*Design constraint: advertising is a scale play and is only commercially meaningful at significant user volume. It should not influence product or UX decisions in V1. The companion view placement protects the planning experience from any commercial dilution.*

## 10.2 Voyager for Business — Corporate Travel Product

Corporate travel has the same core problem Voyager solves — fragmented, time-consuming planning — but with additional complexity: travel policy compliance, preferred supplier lists, expense integration, and approval workflows. A business product addresses this with a B2B SaaS model: sold per seat or per company, with significantly higher ARPU than the consumer product.

This is a separate product build, not a feature addition to the consumer app. It requires different onboarding, an admin layer for company travel policy configuration, and integration with expense management platforms. It is documented here as a future direction only — no build decisions have been made.

### 10.3 Voyager Concierge — Human Interaction Tier

A premium concierge tier where a travel specialist reviews, refines, and personalises the AI-generated itinerary before delivery. Positioned above the High Complexity tier for users who want human oversight on a high-value trip or who are not fully comfortable with a fully AI-built plan.

This tier also addresses the trust gap that some users will have with AI-generated recommendations for expensive or complex trips — a honeymoon, a once-in-a-decade family holiday, or a high-budget experience trip. Priced at a premium above the standard complexity fee; limited availability by design to maintain quality.

*The concierge tier creates a natural upsell path: standard AI plan → High Complexity AI plan → Concierge review. Each step has a clear value increment and price justification.*

## 11. Open Questions — To Be Resolved Before Build

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The following items are noted but not yet decided:

1. Tech stack finalisation — framework choices for frontend and backend, hosting platform, database selection.
2. AI model selection — which LLM powers itinerary generation and confirmation parsing, and whether this is via API or a hosted solution.
3. Payment processing — Stripe or equivalent; handling of NZD pricing and international cards.
4. Link construction methodology — how the AI sources and builds search URLs for each platform; whether a scraping layer is needed or manual URL pattern mapping is sufficient for V1.
5. Account model — what data is stored per user, trip retention policy, and privacy approach.
6. travel insurance referral underwriting partner — identification and commercial terms with a travel insurance provider to underwrite the Assurance product.
7. Advertising platform — ad serving infrastructure and minimum user threshold before advertising is activated.

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*Voyager PRD v2.7 — June 2026. Added Future Revenue Streams section covering in-app advertising, Voyager for Business, and Voyager Concierge tier. All post-V1. Living document — update as decisions are made.*